

FEG Hackathon 2026

EU & Croatia Regulatory Compliance Guide for Participants

Track: Croatian brand (PSK) | As of 4 September 2026

Purpose & Scope

This guide translates the compliance considerations flagged for FEG Hackathon 2026 into practical build guidance for teams working on the Croatian brand (PSK) track. It is an awareness summary for a hackathon proof-of-concept, not legal advice, and does not replace a compliance/legal review — which is required before any solution moves beyond the hackathon.

Official Ground Rules (as communicated to participants)

Common ground rules for all challenges: solutions must comply with the EU regulatory baseline (GDPR, ePrivacy, AMLD/KYC, eIDAS 2.0, EU AI Act, accessibility per EAA/WCAG 2.1 AA) and with responsible gambling principles — no dark patterns, no inducements targeting vulnerable or self-excluded customers, 18+ verification respected throughout. Anonymized, synthetic or sample data only.

What Each Requirement Means for Your Build

Area	What it covers	What this means for your build	Reference
GDPR	Protection of personal data of EU users/players — lawful basis, minimisation, privacy-by-design (Art. 25), DPIA for high-risk profiling, 72h breach notice, player rights.	Never use real personal data. If your demo includes registration or player profiles, use synthetic/sample records only. Design with data minimisation and privacy-by-design in mind, even for a prototype.	Reg. (EU) 2016/679 Official text
ePrivacy	Cookie/tracking consent, terminal-equipment storage, unsolicited marketing (email/SMS/push), traffic/location data.	If your build includes a cookie banner, marketing opt-in, or notification flow, model real opt-in consent (never pre-ticked boxes). <i>Note: a proposed ePrivacy Regulation to replace the Directive is still not adopted — Directive 2002/58/EC (as amended) remains the current binding instrument.</i>	Directive 2002/58/EC
AMLD / KYC	Gambling operators are named “obliged entities”: identity & beneficial-owner verification, ongoing monitoring, source-of-funds checks, enhanced due diligence for higher risk.	If your solution includes onboarding, show a conceptual KYC step (e.g. a document-type selector) using dummy data only — never integrate a real verification service or real IDs. <i>EU is transitioning from the AMLD (national transposition) to a directly applicable AMLR + new EU AML Authority (AMLA); both are relevant during the transition.</i>	AMLD 2015/849 AMLR 2024/1624

Area	What it covers	What this means for your build	Reference
eIDAS 2.0	Electronic identification, e-signatures/seals, trust services, and the EU Digital Identity Wallet (EUDI Wallet).	If age or identity verification is part of your concept, referencing the EUDI Wallet pattern (attribute-based proof, e.g. “over 18” without sharing full ID) is a good forward-looking design choice.	Reg. 910/2014 eIDAS 2.0 (2024/1183)
EU AI Act	Risk-based rules for AI systems (prohibited / high-risk / limited-risk / minimal-risk). Manipulative or exploitative AI practices are prohibited outright.	Any AI/ML feature (recommendations, risk scoring, personalization, fraud/AML detection) must avoid manipulative dark patterns and must not exploit vulnerabilities — this is the same principle behind the “no dark patterns” ground rule. <i>A “Digital Omnibus on AI” entered into force 27 July 2026, deferring high-risk-system obligations by up to 16 months — check the current in-force provisions/timeline.</i>	Reg. (EU) 2024/1689
Accessibility (EAA / WCAG 2.1 AA)	Accessibility requirements for consumer-facing digital services — perceivability, operability, understandability, robustness.	Build demo UIs with basic accessibility in mind: sufficient colour contrast, keyboard navigation, alt text on images, readable font sizes.	Directive 2019/882 WCAG 2.1 AA

Responsible Gambling & Player Protection

- No dark patterns: no manipulative UX designed to nudge continued play, spending, or re-engagement (e.g. disguised ads, forced continuity, fake urgency).
- No inducements to vulnerable or self-excluded customers: no bonus offers, free bets, or push/marketing content targeted at accounts flagged as at-risk or self-excluded.
- 18+ verification respected throughout: age-gating should apply at every relevant entry point in your prototype, not only at registration.
- **EU soft-law baseline:** [Commission Recommendation 2014/478/EU](#) sets non-binding principles (risk information, deposit/spend limits, self-exclusion, staff training, responsible advertising). Croatia's national rules (see below) make several of these binding.

Data Rule — Anonymized, Synthetic or Sample Data Only

No real player or customer data, no real identity documents, and no live production data feeds or APIs may be used in any hackathon build. Use only anonymized, synthetic, or provided sample datasets — this applies across every requirement above and is non-negotiable regardless of a challenge's technical scope.

Croatia (PSK) National Layer

EU regulations set the floor; Croatian national law adds binding requirements on top, particularly for gambling/player-protection controls. Source: FEG compliance research (Sept 2026).

Area	National layer — Croatia (PSK)
Data protection	Act on the Implementation of the GDPR (Zakon o provedbi Opće uredbe o zaštiti podataka) — supervised by the Croatian Data Protection Agency (AZOP).
Gambling / responsible gambling	Act on Games of Chance (Zakon o igrama na sreću) plus its implementing Regulation on Measures for Socially Responsible Organisation of Games of Chance — this is binding, not soft law: it requires ID/age verification and a check against a register of excluded players before play is allowed. Regulator: Ministry of Finance. <i>Build any “self-exclusion” or “age-gate” concept in your prototype as a register-check pattern, not just a UI checkbox.</i>
AML / KYC	National AML framework (Zakon o sprječavanju pranja novca i financiranja terorizma) — administered by the Anti-Money Laundering Office under the Ministry of Finance.
Digital Services Act	Croatia has adopted an implementing act for Regulation (EU) 2022/2065 (DSA), designating national authorities and penalties — relevant if your solution has platform, marketplace, or user-generated-content features.
Gaps to note	<i>Croatian-level transpositions/authority designations for ePrivacy, eIDAS and the AI Act were not independently confirmed in the source material used for this guide — the EU-level instrument in the table above still applies as the floor.</i>

Other EU Instruments Flagged by Compliance (Background Awareness)

These were also shared by the compliance team. Most are not directly triggered by a short hackathon POC but are useful context if a challenge touches these areas, or for anything progressing beyond the hackathon.

Instrument	What it covers / status	Relevance to a hackathon build
NIS2 Directive	Directive (EU) 2022/2555 Cybersecurity risk-management and incident-reporting duties for essential/important entities (18 sectors, size thresholds apply).	Hackathon POCs are almost certainly below scope thresholds. Good practice only: basic security hygiene (no hard-coded secrets, no real credentials, secure-by-design).
EU Data Act	Reg. (EU) 2023/2854 Access/portability rules for data generated by connected (IoT) products and data-processing services; fair (FRAND) data-sharing terms.	Relevant only if your solution involves connected devices or cloud data portability/switching features.
Digital Services Act (general)	Reg. (EU) 2022/2065 Transparency and content-moderation obligations for online intermediaries/platforms; stricter tier for very large platforms.	Relevant if your build has user-generated content, ads, or a recommender system; see also the Croatia-specific DSA note above.
EDPB Guidelines 4/2019 (Art. 25 DPbDD)	EDPB guidance Practical guidance on the “data protection by design and by default” obligation already required under GDPR Art. 25.	Use as the practical how-to for the GDPR privacy-by-design point above.
Digital Omnibus package	Commission proposal page Two strands: the AI strand entered into force 27 Jul 2026 (defers AI Act high-risk timeline). The data/GDPR/ePrivacy/NIS2 strand is still under negotiation, not expected before late 2026.	Rules affecting the AI Act and, later, GDPR/ePrivacy may keep shifting — re-check before any post-hackathon build-out.

Instrument	What it covers / status	Relevance to a hackathon build
CSRD	Directive (EU) 2022/2464 Corporate sustainability reporting duties for large companies (narrowed in 2026 to >1,000 employees / >€450m turnover).	Corporate-level reporting obligation, not a technical build requirement – background only unless your challenge specifically involves ESG data/reporting features.
CS3D (CSDDD)	Summary Supply-chain human-rights/environmental due diligence for very large companies; scope narrowed and transposition delayed to 26 Jul 2028 (compliance from 2029).	Corporate-level, long transposition runway – background only.
EU Taxonomy	Reg. (EU) 2020/852 Classification system for “environmentally sustainable” economic activities, used alongside CSRD reporting.	Background only, unless a challenge track is specifically about sustainability/ESG data.

Sources

Core ground-rule instruments and the Croatia national-layer summary are drawn from FEG compliance-team research (Legora EU & Croatia regulatory compliance guides, Sept 2026) and the EUR-Lex texts linked throughout. The “Other EU Instruments” section reflects publicly available guidance current as of September 2026 and may change as the Digital/Data Omnibus negotiations conclude.

Disclaimer

This guide is an awareness summary prepared for FEG Hackathon 2026 participants. It is not legal advice and does not replace a compliance or legal review. Any solution progressing beyond the hackathon into a real build must be reviewed by FEG Legal & Compliance before it processes any real data or goes live.